

MANNING ZHANG

Brandeis University
415 South St., MS 071
Waltham, MA 02453

+1 (781) 869-0164
manningz33@brandeis.edu
Sep 2026

EDUCATION

Expected in Aug. 2027	Joint Ph.D. in Social Policy and Sociology, <i>Brandeis University</i> , Waltham, MA
May 2023	M.A. , Social Policy, <i>Brandeis University</i> , Waltham, MA
Jun. 2020	B.L. , Sociology, <i>Fudan University</i> , Shanghai, China
	Bachelor's Thesis: <i>Chinese Farmer's Identity and Land Consciousness in an Urbanizing Era</i> Advisors: Yi Zhou, Ronggui Huang
Jun. 2020	Minor Certificate , French Language, <i>Shanghai International Studies University</i> Shanghai, China

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Health Governance; Medical Sociology; Sociology of Culture; Sociology of Knowledge; Science and Technology Studies; Health Policy; Fitness.

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-reviewed Articles

2026	Ressler, Robert, Zhang, Manning , Leonardos, Madeline, Noelke, Clemens, Acevedo-Garcia, Dolores. (2026). Structural Racism, Neighborhood Opportunity, and Racial/Ethnic Disparities in Homicide Risk. Preprint available Online: https://www.medrxiv.org/content/10.64898/2026.06.29.26356868v1
2026	Haque, Zora, Zhang, Manning ¹ , Meschede, Tatjana, Warfield, Marji. (2026). Undoing the STEM/non-STEM Boundary: Exploring Women's STEM-Related Experiences and Binary Definitions of STEM Involvement, <i>Gender, Work & Organization</i> . 33(6): 2171–2184.
2025	Zhang, Manning , Ressler, Robert, Noelke, Clemens, Acevedo-Garcia, Dolores. (2025). Disparities in Violent Deaths by Neighborhood Opportunity with the Child Opportunity Index 3.0, Preliminary Results, <i>AJPM Focus</i> . 4(4):100357.
2021	Ma, Ruofan & Zhang, Manning & Oakman, Jonathan & Wang, Jiping & Zhu, Ziqi & Zhao, Chendi & Hu, Zhiyuan & Buchanan, Nicole. (2021). Eating disorders treatment experiences and social support: Perspectives from service seekers in mainland China. <i>International Journal of Eating Disorders</i> . 54(8):1537-1548.
2021	Ma, Ruofan & Oakman, Jonathan & Zhang, Manning & Zhang, Xianni & Chen, Wei & Buchanan, Nicole. (2021). Lessons for mental health systems

¹ The article is co-first-authored.

from the COVID-19 frontline: Chinese healthcare workers' challenges, resources, resilience, and cultural considerations. *Traumatology*. 27(4), 432–443.

Book Chapters and Book Reviews

- 2025 **Zhang, Manning** (2025). Gamification of Fitness and Training in Jacob Bustad and Gashaw Abeza (Eds.), *Technology, Sport and Recreation: Physical Activity in the Digital Age*. Routledge.
- 2024 **Zhang, Manning**. (2024). “Book Review: The Quest for Sexual Health: How an Elusive Ideal Has Transformed Science, Politics, and Everyday Life.” *Sexualities*.

Selected Policy Reports

- 2026 Meschede, Tatjana, Stewart, Sylvia, and **Zhang, Manning**. (2026) Leveraging Mobility in Boston: Economic Well-Being and the Flow of Wealth Across Three Generations of Low- and Middle-Income Families. *Institute for Economic and Racial Equity, The Heller School for Social Policy and Management, Brandeis University*. <https://heller.brandeis.edu/iere/pdfs/racial-wealth-equity/leveraging-mobility/leveraging-mobility-in-boston-compressed.pdf>
- 2023 Loya, Rebecca, Smith-Gibbs, Madeline, and **Zhang, Manning**. (2023) Increasing Access to Postsecondary Education Savings: Strategies for Designing Equitable 529 Programs. *Institute for Economic and Racial Equity, The Heller School for Social Policy and Management, Brandeis University*. https://buildcommonwealth.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/02/CW_Increasing-Access-to-Postsecondary-Education-Savings.pdf

Selected Public Writings

- 2026 Xie, Qiuyi, **Zhang, Manning**. (2026, September 15). Early-Stage Financing for Hard-Tech Startups in the Yangtze River Delta: Direct Investment by State-Owned Capital Becomes a Trend, While Cross-Provincial Collaboration Gains Momentum. *ThePaper.cn* (澎湃新闻研究所). https://m.thepaper.cn/newsDetail_forward_34066468 (In Mandarin)
- 2025 **Zhang, Manning**. (2025, June 10). Interview with Musa al-Gharbi. *ASA Culture Section Newsletter*. <https://asaculturesection.org/2025/06/10/interview-with-musa-al-gharbi/> (Other interviews are available on the culture newsletter website).
- 2024 **Zhang, Manning**. (2024, December 11). What Is the Boundary of Global Health? *Open-Air Journal*. <https://openairjournal.substack.com/p/what-is-the-boundary-of-global-health?r=1ez6az>
- 2024 **Zhang, Manning**. (2024, April 30). Climate Change and Green Gentrification. *Open-Air Journal*. <https://openairjournal.substack.com/p/climate-change-and-green-gentrification>

WORK IN PROGRESS

- Zhang, Manning**. Re-politicize Health: Intersected Inequities in Health Knowledge Production and Application. (Under revision; to be submitted to *Sociology of Health & Illness*)
- Zhang, Manning**. “Centralizing lifestyle in status-making.” (Under revision; to be submitted to *Sociological Inquiry*)
- Zhang, Manning**. “Fitness as a Temporal Craft: A Two-Wave Interview Study of Exercise in Early Adulthood.” (Submitted for paper competition; to be submitted to *Leisure Studies*).

Zhang, Manning. “Building Community Through Fitness: The YMCA and the Social Life of Exercise.” (Drafting)

Zhang, Manning. “Making Sense of Fitness and Health: Young Adults’ Understandings of Well-Being in Campus Recreation Spaces.” (Drafting)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

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| 2026 | “The Politics of Health Knowledge Production: Intersectional Inequities and Obesity Governance in China.” British Sociological Association Medical Sociology Group Annual Conference , Newcastle Upon Tyne, England, September. |
| 2025 | “Re-politicize Health: Intersected Inequities in Health Knowledge Production and Application.” American Sociological Association Annual Conference , Chicago, IL, August. |
| 2024 | “Not by Accident: The Technological Production of Embodied Health Inequalities.” and “Undoing the STEM/non-STEM boundary: Exploring Women’s STEM-Related Experiences and Binary Definitions of STEM Involvement.” American Sociological Association Annual Conference and The Society for the Study of Social Problems Annual Meeting , Montréal, Canada, August. |
| 2024 | “Status: A Hierarchy of Honor.” and “Understanding Health Technology and Inequality.” (in Mandarin), Chinese Sociological Association Annual Conference , Harbin, China, July. |
| 2024 | “Unveiling the Impact of Bike Infrastructure on Urban Neighborhood Transformation in the Greater Boston Area.” Boston Area Research Initiative (BARI) Conference 2024: Greater Boston’s Annual Insight-to-Impact Summit , Boston, MA, April. |
| 2024 | “Boston Moving: Fitness Clubs and Community-Making Practices.” American Sociological Association Community and Urban Sociology Section Virtual Mini-Conference: Building Communities in Research and Practice , virtual, April. |
| 2024 | “Tackling the Bamboo Ceiling: Experience of Early-stage Immigrant Asian Women Scholars in the United States.” 2024 Education & Health Research Hub Conference at George Mason University , virtual, February. |
| 2023 | “Fit for Good: Contested Social Class, Gender and Racial Contexts in the Weight Room.” American Sociological Association Annual Conference , Philadelphia, PA, August. |
| 2023 | “The Migration Old: Exploring Chinese Senior Rural-Urban Population in the Past 30 Years with the Age-Period-Cohort Model.” Population Association of America Applied Demographic Conference , Annapolis, MD, February. |
| 2022 | “Asian Women in the Weight Room.” Eastern Sociological Society 91st Annual Conference , Boston, MA, March. |

- 2021 “Her Voice: A Literary Analysis on Asian Women Scholars in American Academia.” **Chinese Sociological Association Annual Conference**, Chongqing, China, July.
- 2020 “Chinese Farmers’ Identity and Land Consciousness in an Urbanizing Era.” **Chinese Sociological Association Annual Conference**, virtual, June.
- 2019 “Socially Constructed Volunteering Experiences: A Qualitative Study among Undergraduate Students in Elite Universities in Shanghai.” **Shanghai Sociological Association Annual Conference**, virtual, June.

FELLOWSHIPS, GRANTS, AWARDS AND FUNDS

Fellowships and Grants

- 2026 Wyatt Jones and James Schulz Dissertation Grant, **Brandeis University**, Waltham, MA - **\$3,000**.
- 2024 Social Justice Internship Fellowship, **Brandeis University**, Waltham, MA - **\$2,956**
- 2024 2024 APPAM Equity and Inclusion Fellowship, **Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM)**, Washington, DC - **\$1,389**
- 2024 Sagan Family Grant for Graduate Research, **Brandeis University**, Waltham, MA - **\$1,000**
- 2022 summer and fall The GSAS Connected PhD Career Development Fellowship, **Brandeis University**, Waltham, MA – **\$12,000**

Awards and Funds

- 2026 Berkowitz Dissertation Research Prize, **Sociology Department of Brandeis University**, Waltham, MA - **\$600**.
- 2026 Roberta L. Lipson ‘76 and Ted Plafker Endowed Travel to China Fund, **Brandeis University**, Waltham, MA - **\$2,500**
- 2026 Heller School Student Dissertation Enrichment Fund, **Brandeis University**, Waltham, MA - **\$3,000**
- 2024 2024 Three-Minute Thesis Competition First Place Prize (Humanities/Creative Arts/Social Sciences category), **Brandeis University**, Waltham, MA - **\$1,000**
- 2024 Provost Doctoral Research Award, **Brandeis University**, Waltham, MA - **\$1,000**
- 2023 The GSAS PhD Research Award, **Brandeis University**, Waltham, MA - **\$1,000**
- 2022 Heller School Student Enrichment Fund, **Brandeis University**, Waltham, MA - **\$700**

2022	The Peter Conrad Award for Graduate Student Pre-Dissertation Research, Brandeis University , Waltham, MA - \$600
2020	Scholarship of New Career Trajectories for the Ph.D. Seminar Series, Brandeis University , Waltham, MA - \$400
2018 and 2020	Undergraduate National Scholarship (GPA #1), Fudan University , Shanghai, China - \$1,000
2019	The Excellent Paper Award, Shanghai Sociological Association Annual Conference , Shanghai, China

RESEARCH POSITIONS HELD

Nov 2024 – Apr 2026	Retirement and Mobility Qualitative Researcher. Supervisor: Sylvia Stewart, Tatjana Meschede, Institute for Economic and Racial Equity at Brandeis University , Waltham, MA ·Facilitate the data analysis of longitudinal research on people's retirement financial plans.
Nov 2024 – Dec 2025	Disability Policy Qualitative Researcher. Supervisor: Anne Valentine and Lauren Smith, Lurie Institute for Disability Policy at Brandeis University , Waltham, MA ·Conduct online landscape research on medical professionals' pedagogy concerning pregnant patients with disabilities.
May 2023 – Dec 2024	STEM Education and Gender Equality Researcher. Supervisor: Zora Haque, Marji Warfield, Institute for Economic and Racial Equity at Brandeis University , Waltham, MA ·Collected interview data with 42 STEM educational program participants. ·Transcribed and analyzed the interview data amounting to 60 hours.
Oct 2021 – May 2025	Quantitative Research Intern for <i>diversitydatakids.org</i> Project. Advisor: Clemens Noelke, Robert Ressler, Institute for Child, Youth and Family Policy at Brandeis University , Waltham, MA ·Merged Child Opportunity Index data with Census datasets using Stata ·Analyzed national demographic and violent-death data ·Led a paper submitted to JAMA ·Created maps for Child Opportunity Index mapping with R. ·Conducted literature review based on ECLS-K data profile.
May 2022 – Dec 2022	Economic and Asset Researcher. Supervisor: Rebecca Loya and Madeline Smith-Gibbs, Institute for Economic and Racial Equity at Brandeis University , Waltham, MA ·Drafted data collection instruments for interviews. ·Documented and coded semi-structured interviews with 529 plan stakeholders. ·Co-wrote a 23-page policy evaluation report with the research team and Commonwealth. (Report name: <i>Increasing Access to Postsecondary Education Savings</i>)

- 2022 Summer Data Analyst and Modeler. Supervisor: Daniel J. Guhr, **Illuminate Consulting Group L.L.C.**; Haley Rosenfeld and Abigail Arnold, **Brandeis University**, Waltham, MA
- Retrieved, cleaned, merged, and analyzed academic and scientific research performance metrics from various data repositories and rankings, along with Brandeis data on doctoral programs and research funding.
- 2019 – 2021 Research assistant on a granted project on the social credit system in mainland China. Advisor: Cheris Shun-ching Chan, **University of Hong Kong**. Remote
- Reviewed mainstream newspaper archives from 1990 to 2019.
 - Recruited more than 20 interviewees.
 - Transcribed more than 20 recordings.
 - Wrote more than 10 brief reports to summarize the materials.

TEACHING AND MENTORSHIP

Primary Instructor

- 2025 Summer Undergraduate 4-credit seminar: *Applied Research Methods*. **Brandeis University**.
- 2024 Fall *Divergent Identity: Unraveling China's Traditional and Modern Cultural Phenomena (5-class series)*. **Brandeis Osher Lifelong Learning Institute**.
- 2024 Summer Undergraduate 4-credit seminar: *Observing the Social World: Doing Qualitative Sociology*. **Brandeis University**.

Teaching/Course Assistant

- 2024 Spring *Introduction to International Relations*. **Brandeis University**.
- 2024 Spring & 2023 Spring, Fall *Order and Change in Society*. **Brandeis University**.
- 2023 Spring *Health, Community and Society*. **Brandeis University**.
- 2022 and 2023 Fall *Basic Statistics for Social and Political Analysis*. **Brandeis University**.
- 2022 Fall *Sociology of Body and Health*. **Brandeis University**.
- 2022 Spring *Sociology of Education*. **Brandeis University**.
- 2021 Fall *Sociology of Reproduction*. **Brandeis University**.

Mentorship Experience

- 2025 Spring Writing Fellow, **Brandeis University Writing Center**, Waltham, MA
- Assisted the director in the administrative operations of the Writing Center.
 - Maintained the documentation of the administrative workflow.

2024 Fall	Graduate Writing Assistant, Brandeis University Student Support Services Program (TRIO) , Waltham, MA · Provided writing-related advice to first-generation college students from resource-restricted backgrounds.
2023-2024	Senior Writing Consultant, Brandeis University Writing Center , Waltham, MA · Managed the administrative operation of the University Writing Center. · Led regular workshops and graduate collaborative writing sessions.
2023-2024	Undergraduate Research Lead Mentor, Brandeis University , Waltham, MA · Managed the peer research mentor team consisting of 18 graduate and undergraduate students. · Organized 2 major recruitment events and 1 research networking event.
2022 Spring	Undergraduate Thesis Mentor, Brandeis University , Waltham, MA

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

2024-2026	Student Representative, American Sociological Association, Culture Section.
2023-2024	Student Representative, American Sociological Association, Decision-making, Networks, and Society Section.
2021-2026	Editorial Board Member, American Sociological Association, Sociology of Culture Section Newsletter. <i>Editor-in-Chief:</i> Term 1 September to November 2021 Term 2 May to July 2022 Term 3 May to July 2023 Term 4 May to July 2024

SKILLS

Software	R, Stata, NVivo, ATLAS.ti, SPSS, ArcGIS, Python, Adobe Creative Suite
Languages	Mandarin (<i>native</i>), English (<i>professional</i>), Spanish (Duolingo level 23).

REFERENCES

Dr. Laura J. Miller (Dissertation Committee Chair)
Professor of Sociology, Brandeis University
lamiller@brandeis.edu
(+1) 781-736-2643

Dr. Siri Suh
Associate Professor of Sociology, Brandeis University
jssuh@brandeis.edu
(+1) 781-736-2635

Dr. Christine E. Bishop
Professor, Heller School for Social Policy and Management, Brandeis University
bishop@brandeis.edu
(+1) 781-736-3942

Dr. Tatjana Meschede
Associate Director of the Heller School's Institute for Economic and Racial Equity, Brandeis University
meschede@brandeis.edu
(+1) 781-736-8678